

December

22



1891

It's a rip off!

US inventor Seth Wheeler became the first person to sell perforated toilet paper in the USA. Though toilet paper was not new, his design allowed the user to easily tear off sheets.

Also on this day

1788 **Quang Trung** proclaimed himself emperor of Vietnam.

1938 A **coelacanth**, a fish believed to have been extinct for 66 million years, was found in South Africa.

1971 **Médecins Sans Frontières** was founded. This humanitarian medical organization works globally to provide health care, particularly in regions with war and disease.

1882

Christmas lights

Edward H Johnson, a US inventor, was the first person to use electric lights to decorate a Christmas tree. Before this, wax candles were used, which could be very dangerous.



Born this day

1960 **Jean-Michel Basquiat**, Black American artist. He mixed graffiti and painting to make unique artworks.

1962 **Ralph Fiennes**, British actor. He played the role of Voldemort in the *Harry Potter* films.

Brandenburg Gate reopens

1989

Closed for almost 30 years, the Brandenburg Gate reopened in Berlin, Germany. The landmark had become a symbol of the division of both the city and the country after World War II. Its reopening signalled the end of the Cold War, and Germany reunited a year later.

